LESSON 4

The Good Samaritan Model of Herbal Ministry

Compassion • Mercy • Service • Practical Care

Course: NHMEC Biblical Herbalism Foundations
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Lesson: Lesson 4
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Lesson Overview

In Lesson 1, we learned that Biblical Herbalism begins with God as Creator. In Lesson 2, we learned what it means to be a Christian herbalist. In Lesson 3, we studied discernment and the importance of keeping herbal education aligned with Scripture.

In this lesson, we will study one of the strongest biblical pictures of compassionate care:

The Good Samaritan.

The Good Samaritan is not usually introduced as an “herbalist,” but his actions show us a model of mercy, practical care, sacrifice, and service. He saw a wounded man, stopped to help, bound up his wounds, poured in oil and wine, placed him on his own animal, brought him to an inn, paid for his care, and promised to return.

For the Christian herbal student, this story teaches that herbal ministry must never be built on pride, performance, or profit alone. It must be built on love for God and love for neighbor.

The Good Samaritan model teaches us that Christian herbalism should be:

Compassionate
Practical
Responsible
Sacrificial
Safe
Humble
Merciful
Rooted in service

A Christian herbalist is not called to simply know herbs. A Christian herbalist is called to love people well.

Lesson Scripture Foundations

Luke 10:30–37 KJV

“And Jesus answering said, A certain man went down from Jerusalem to Jericho, and fell among thieves, which stripped him of his raiment, and wounded him, and departed, leaving him half dead.

And by chance there came down a certain priest that way: and when he saw him, he passed by on the other side.

And likewise a Levite, when he was at the place, came and looked on him, and passed by on the other side.

But a certain Samaritan, as he journeyed, came where he was: and when he saw him, he had compassion on him,

And went to him, and bound up his wounds, pouring in oil and wine, and set him on his own beast, and brought him to an inn, and took care of him.

And on the morrow when he departed, he took out two pence, and gave them to the host, and said unto him, Take care of him; and whatsoever thou spendest more, when I come again, I will repay thee.

Which now of these three, thinkest thou, was neighbour unto him that fell among the thieves?

And he said, He that shewed mercy on him. Then said Jesus unto him, Go, and do thou likewise.”

Matthew 22:37–39 KJV

“Jesus said unto him, Thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind.

This is the first and great commandment.

And the second is like unto it, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.”

Galatians 6:2 KJV

“Bear ye one another's burdens, and so fulfil the law of Christ.”

Proverbs 19:17 KJV

“He that hath pity upon the poor lendeth unto the LORD; and that which he hath given will he pay him again.”

James 2:15–17 KJV

“If a brother or sister be naked, and destitute of daily food,

And one of you say unto them, Depart in peace, be ye warmed and filled; notwithstanding ye give them not those things which are needful to the body; what doth it profit?

Even so faith, if it hath not works, is dead, being alone.”

Lesson Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students should be able to:

1. Explain the Good Samaritan story as a model of Christian compassion.
2. Identify the spiritual, emotional, and practical lessons in Luke 10:30–37.
3. Understand how mercy and service apply to Biblical Herbalism.
4. Explain why Christian herbal ministry must include wisdom, safety, and boundaries.
5. Recognize the difference between helping and overstepping.
6. Describe how oil and wine were used in the biblical story without making modern medical claims.
7. Create a personal Good Samaritan ministry reflection.

Opening Teaching

Jesus did not tell the story of the Good Samaritan simply to give us a lesson about kindness. He told it to reveal the heart of true neighborly love.

In the story, a man was robbed, stripped, wounded, and left half dead. He was vulnerable. He could not help himself. He was in a dangerous place. He needed someone to see him, stop, care, and act.

Two religious men saw him and passed by. They had position, knowledge, and religious identity, but they did not stop to help. Then a Samaritan came. In that culture, the Samaritan would not have been expected to be the hero of the story. Yet he was the one who showed mercy.

This matters for the Christian herbal student.

It is possible to have knowledge and still lack compassion.
It is possible to have titles and still pass by the wounded.
It is possible to know Scripture and still ignore suffering.
It is possible to study herbs and still miss the heart of ministry.

The Good Samaritan reminds us that ministry is not proven by how much we know. Ministry is proven by love in action.

The Wounded Man

The wounded man represents people who are hurting, overwhelmed, abandoned, ashamed, sick, grieving, confused, or broken.

Some wounds are visible.
Some wounds are hidden.
Some wounds are physical.
Some wounds are emotional.
Some wounds are spiritual.
Some wounds are relational.
Some wounds come from trauma, loss, neglect, poverty, loneliness, or fear.

A Christian herbalist must learn to see people with compassion, not judgment.

When someone comes for wellness education, they may not only need information. They may need patience, prayer, encouragement, rest, nourishment, listening, and hope. They may also need licensed medical care, emergency care, counseling, pastoral support, or community resources.

The Good Samaritan did not ignore the wounded man. He recognized the need and responded.

A Christian herbalist should ask:

What does this person truly need?
Is this within my role?
Can I safely educate?
Do they need medical care?
Do they need prayer?
Do they need food, rest, or support?
Do they need someone to listen?
How can I serve without overstepping?

Compassion begins with seeing.

The Priest and the Levite

The priest and Levite saw the man but passed by.

This part of the story is uncomfortable because it reminds us that religious identity does not always equal mercy. A person can know religious language but fail to love. A person can hold a position but fail to act. A person can be busy with ministry and still ignore the wounded.

For the Christian herbal student, this is a warning.

We must not become so focused on courses, certificates, formulas, herbs, and knowledge that we forget people.

Herbal education must not become cold.
Ministry must not become performance.
Wellness work must not become pride.
Christian service must not become self-promotion.

The priest and Levite passed by on the other side. The Good Samaritan crossed the distance.

A Christian herbalist should be willing to cross the distance with compassion while still walking in wisdom.

The Samaritan Had Compassion

Luke 10:33 says that when the Samaritan saw the wounded man, **he had compassion on him.**

Compassion is more than feeling sorry. Compassion moves toward action.

Compassion says:

“I see you.”
“You matter.”
“I will not ignore your suffering.”
“I will help in the way I am able.”
“I will not shame you.”
“I will not use your pain for my gain.”
“I will serve with mercy.”

A Christian herbalist must be careful that herbal work does not become transactional only. Yes, education centers, courses, consultations, supplies, and materials may have costs. But the heart behind the work must remain service.

Compassion protects us from becoming harsh.

Compassion reminds us that behind every wellness question is a person created in the image of God.

He Went to Him

The Samaritan did not help from a distance only. Scripture says he “went to him.”

This teaches presence.

In Christian herbal ministry, presence may look like:

Listening carefully
Taking time to understand
Praying with someone when appropriate
Offering encouragement
Providing educational resources
Teaching simple skills
Helping someone understand safety
Referring them to proper care
Following up when appropriate
Serving without rushing

Presence does not mean we take responsibility for everything in another person's life. It means we show care within our proper role.

A Christian herbalist should not become someone's savior. Jesus is the Savior. But a Christian herbalist can be present, kind, wise, and helpful.

He Bound Up His Wounds

The Samaritan responded to the immediate need. He bound up the man's wounds.

This teaches practical care.

Christian herbalism should not only be theory. It should help students understand practical ways to support wellness within safe educational boundaries.

Practical care may include teaching about:

Cleanliness
Rest
Hydration
Nourishing foods
Herbal teas for general comfort
Simple salves for general skin care
Safe topical preparations
Basic first-aid awareness
When to seek urgent medical care
How to create a family wellness kit
How to label herbs properly
How to store preparations safely

However, students must understand that serious wounds, infection, uncontrolled bleeding, severe pain, burns, allergic reactions, broken bones, deep cuts, or emergency symptoms require medical care.

The Good Samaritan cared practically, but modern Christian herbal students must also understand modern safety responsibilities.

He Poured in Oil and Wine

The Good Samaritan poured in oil and wine. In the biblical setting, oil and wine were practical resources available to him. Oil was commonly used in daily life, and wine was also used in various household and cultural contexts.

For this course, we study this detail carefully and responsibly.

We do not use this verse to make modern medical claims.
We do not use this verse to say students should treat wounds without medical care.
We do not use this verse to replace first aid, sterile care, or emergency treatment.
We do not use this verse to create a prescription.

Instead, we learn the principle:

The Good Samaritan used what he had available to provide compassionate, practical care.

For the Christian herbalist, this points to the importance of preparation.

A Christian herbalist should learn basic wellness skills before crisis comes. A family herbalist should learn how to make simple preparations safely. A ministry leader should learn how to organize supplies responsibly. A wellness educator should know when something is outside their scope.

Oil and wine in this story remind us that care can be both spiritual and practical.

Pray, but also help.
Encourage, but also serve.
Teach, but also prepare.
Love, but also act wisely.

He Set Him on His Own Beast

The Samaritan gave up his own comfort to help the wounded man.

This shows sacrifice.

Compassion often costs something.

It may cost time.
It may cost energy.

It may cost convenience.
It may cost money.
It may cost emotional effort.
It may cost personal comfort.

Christian herbal ministry should be willing to serve, but it must also be wise. Sacrifice does not mean burnout. Sacrifice does not mean having no boundaries. Sacrifice does not mean taking on responsibilities God did not give you.

The Good Samaritan did what he could and involved others when needed. He brought the man to an inn. This is important.

He did not try to do everything alone.

He Brought Him to an Inn

The inn represents additional care and community support.

This is one of the most important lessons for Christian herbalists.

Sometimes the most responsible thing we can do is connect someone to the right help.

A Christian herbalist may need to refer someone to:

A physician
Emergency care
A pharmacist
A licensed counselor
A pastor
A nutrition professional
A midwife or OB provider
A specialist
A community resource
A food pantry
A domestic violence resource
A crisis hotline
A support group

Referral is not failure. Referral is wisdom.

The Samaritan helped, but he also brought the wounded man to a place where care could continue.

A Christian herbalist should never be ashamed to say:

“This is outside my role.”
“This needs medical attention.”
“I encourage you to contact your healthcare provider.”
“You deserve more support than I can provide in this setting.”
“Let’s make sure you are safe.”

Good ministry knows when to involve others.

He Paid for Care

The Good Samaritan used his own resources. He paid the innkeeper and promised to repay any additional cost.

This shows generosity.

Christian herbal ministry should be generous in spirit. This does not mean everything must be free. Education centers, teachers, herbalists, and ministries need resources to operate. Supplies cost money. Time has value. Training has value.

But the heart must remain generous.

Generosity may look like:

Offering prayer
Sharing basic education
Creating free handouts
Giving a simple recipe
Teaching a community class
Offering sliding-scale options when possible
Creating donation-based resources
Helping someone find affordable options
Serving without exploiting pain

A Christian herbalist must guard against greed. People in pain should not be manipulated. Fear should not be used to sell products. Suffering should not be used as a marketing tool.

The Good Samaritan gave from compassion, not greed.

He Promised to Return

The Good Samaritan did not abandon the wounded man after one act of care. He promised to return and check on the situation.

This teaches follow-through.

In Christian herbal education, follow-through may include:

Checking in after a class
Reviewing a student's assignment
Encouraging a client to follow up with their provider
Offering continued education
Keeping proper records
Providing clear instructions
Correcting misinformation
Updating resources
Maintaining integrity

Follow-through builds trust.

A Christian herbalist should not make promises they cannot keep. But when we say we will do something, we should do it.

Let your yes be yes.

The Good Samaritan Model for Christian Herbalism

The Good Samaritan model can be remembered in seven steps:

1. See the Need

Do not ignore suffering.

2. Have Compassion

Let love move your heart.

3. Move Toward the Person

Be present and attentive.

4. Give Practical Care

Use wisdom and safe, appropriate support.

5. Use Available Resources

Serve with what God has placed in your hand.

6. Refer and Involve Others

Know when continued care is needed.

7. Follow Through

Do not abandon responsibility.

This model helps Christian herbal students understand that herbal ministry is not only about plants. It is about people.

Applying the Good Samaritan Model to Herbal Education

A Christian herbalist might apply this model in many ways.

For a family member, it may mean teaching a simple tea recipe for general comfort and reminding them to seek medical care if symptoms are serious.

For a community class, it may mean teaching safe herbal preparations and including disclaimers.

For a ministry setting, it may mean creating a prayer and wellness kit with scripture, comfort items, and clear safety instructions.

For a client, it may mean listening with compassion, providing educational support, and referring them to a licensed provider when needed.

For a disaster relief setting, it may mean organizing practical supplies, hydration support, hygiene kits, prayer cards, and basic wellness education without making medical claims.

For a student, it may mean learning how to serve without rushing into authority before being properly trained.

The Good Samaritan model keeps the Christian herbalist grounded in love, wisdom, and humility.

Boundaries in Good Samaritan Ministry

The Good Samaritan helped, but he did not act carelessly. Christian herbalists must understand boundaries.

Healthy boundaries include:

Staying within educational scope
Not diagnosing
Not prescribing

Not promising healing
Not replacing medical care
Not handling emergencies alone
Not giving herbs without safety knowledge
Not taking responsibility for someone's medical decisions
Not becoming emotionally overwhelmed by every need
Not serving without rest, prayer, and accountability

Boundaries do not mean lack of love. Boundaries protect love from becoming disorder.

A Christian herbalist can care deeply and still say:

"I cannot provide medical advice."
"This needs a doctor."
"I can pray with you."
"I can share general education."
"I can help you think through questions to ask your provider."
"I can point you to resources."
"I can teach you what I know within my role."

This is responsible ministry.

Compassion Without Claims

The Good Samaritan model teaches compassion, but it does not give permission to make unsafe claims.

A Christian herbalist should avoid saying:

"This oil will heal your wound."
"This herb will cure your disease."
"This formula works better than medicine."
"You do not need a doctor."
"God told me this will heal you."
"If you had enough faith, you would be healed."

Instead, use language such as:

"This is for educational purposes only."
"This herb has been traditionally used for general wellness support."
"This is not a replacement for medical care."
"Please seek medical help for serious or worsening symptoms."
"Let's pray for wisdom."
"God is the healer, and we want to walk in wisdom."

Compassion and caution can work together.

The Heart of Herbal Ministry

The heart of herbal ministry is not the herb cabinet. It is not the certificate. It is not the title. It is not the formula. It is not the product.

The heart of herbal ministry is love.

Love God.
Love your neighbor.
Love truth.
Love wisdom.
Love safety.
Love mercy.
Love people more than platforms.
Love obedience more than attention.

The Good Samaritan was remembered because he showed mercy.

Jesus ended the story by saying:

“Go, and do thou likewise.”

This is the call for the Christian herbalist.

Go with compassion.
Go with wisdom.
Go with safety.
Go with prayer.
Go with humility.
Go with mercy.
Go with Christ.

Teacher’s Teaching Notes

When teaching this lesson, emphasize that the Good Samaritan model is not a license to provide medical treatment. It is a model of compassion, mercy, responsible action, and practical care.

Students may be tempted to see the oil and wine and immediately create formulas or protocols. Slow them down. Teach them to look first at the heart of the passage.

The main lesson is not “make oil and wine remedies.”

The main lesson is:

See the hurting.
Have compassion.
Serve wisely.
Use what is available.
Involve others when needed.
Follow through.
Show mercy.

This lesson is also a good place to remind students that Christian herbalism must include both heart and hands. We pray, but we also prepare. We believe God heals, but we also serve responsibly. We study herbs, but we never forget people.

Student Reflection

Answer the following questions in your notebook or student workbook.

1. What part of the Good Samaritan story stands out to you most?
2. Why do you think Jesus chose a Samaritan as the example of mercy?
3. How can religious people sometimes miss compassion?
4. What does it mean to “see” the wounded today?
5. How can a Christian herbalist show compassion without overstepping?
6. What does oil and wine teach us about practical care in the biblical context?
7. Why is referral an important part of responsible ministry?
8. How can herbal ministry become harmful if it lacks boundaries?
9. What does “Go, and do thou likewise” mean for you as a student?
10. How can you serve others with mercy while keeping Christ at the center?

Optional Discussion Board Prompt

Post your answer inside the PENothecary™ student space:

What does “Go, and do thou likewise” mean for a Christian herbal student?

Respond to at least one classmate with encouragement, scripture, or a thoughtful reflection.

Vocabulary Words

Compassion: Christlike concern that sees suffering and moves toward mercy.

Mercy: Kindness and care shown to someone in need.

Practical Care: Helpful action that meets real needs in a wise and responsible way.

Referral: Directing someone to appropriate professional, medical, pastoral, or community support.

Boundary: A wise limit that protects both the helper and the person receiving help.

Ministry: Service done unto the Lord for the good of others.

Follow-Through: Continuing to act responsibly after the first moment of help.

Good Samaritan Model: A biblical pattern of seeing need, showing compassion, giving practical care, involving others, and following through.

Lesson 4 Summary

The Good Samaritan story gives Christian herbal students a powerful model of mercy and service. The Samaritan saw a wounded man, had compassion, went to him, bound up his wounds, poured in oil and wine, brought him to an inn, paid for his care, and promised to return.

This story teaches that Christian herbalism must be more than knowledge. It must be rooted in love for God and love for neighbor.

The Christian herbalist must learn to see the hurting, serve with compassion, use practical wisdom, involve others when needed, and stay within proper boundaries. Oil and wine in the story remind us that care can be practical, but they should not be used as a reason to make modern medical claims or replace medical care.

Remember:

See the need.
Have compassion.
Move toward mercy.
Serve practically.
Use wisdom.
Refer when needed.
Follow through.
Go and do likewise.

Closing Prayer

Father God,

Thank You for the example of the Good Samaritan. Teach me to see people with compassion and not pass by those who are hurting. Give me a heart that is willing to serve, hands that are prepared to help, and wisdom to know my boundaries.

Help me never use herbal knowledge for pride, control, or gain. Let my studies become a way to love my neighbor better. Teach me when to pray, when to listen, when to teach, when to give practical support, and when to refer someone to proper care.

Keep my ministry humble, safe, Christ-centered, and full of mercy.

In Jesus' name,
Amen.

Instructor Closing

Students, the Good Samaritan model reminds us that Christian herbalism is not only about plants. It is about people.

The wounded are still on the road. Some are wounded in body. Some are wounded in soul. Some are wounded in spirit. Some need prayer. Some need food. Some need rest. Some need encouragement. Some need a doctor. Some need safety. Some need someone who will not pass by.

As Christian herbal students, we must learn to serve with both compassion and wisdom.

Do not pass by.
Do not overstep.
Do not make claims.
Do not replace God.
Do not replace medical care.

See the need.
Show mercy.
Serve wisely.
Refer responsibly.
Keep Christ at the center.

Jesus said, "Go, and do thou likewise."